

Iluvatar (9903.HK): China GPU in strong demand while raw material supply remains tight; 1H26 in line; Buy

Iluvatar's 1H26 revenue was up 192% YoY / 33% HoH, largely in line with our estimate and Bloomberg consensus, reflecting the strong AI chips demand in China. 1H26 GM declined YoY and HoH to 17.2%, lower than our estimate and Bloomberg consensus, which we attribute to the rising cost of key components, such as HBM. Opex ratio improved to 84.5% in 1H26, better than our estimate and Bloomberg consensus, along with the higher-than-expected non-op gains from fair value gains on financial assets, leading to a positive net income in 1H26, in line with our estimate and the company's guidance. In 1H26, Iluvatar had large scale deployment across internet, AI large models, financial services, healthcare, scientific research and other sectors and served over 380 customers, with training / inferencing GPGPU revenue up 38% / 652% YoY, reflecting the company benefiting from the rising AI infrastructure end-demand in local market. We remain positive on Iluvatar's strong shipments growth ahead and product mix upgrade towards next generation products, while the tight supply of key components could cap the company's shipments and profitability. Maintain Buy. **Read more:** [China GPU TAM launch](#).

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Exhibit 1: 1H26 result snapshot

Rmb m	1H25	2H25	1H26	YoY	HoH	GS	Act / GS	Cons.	Act / Cons.	Guid. ct / Guid.
Revenues	324	709	946	192%	33%	916	3%	985	-4%	
GP	162	396	163	0%	-59%	442	-63%	479	-66%	
OP	-631	-418	-637	na	na	-681	na	-469	na	
Net income	-609	-394	106	na	na	101	6%	-416	na	100 6%
Margins										
GM	50.1%	55.8%	17.2%			48.2%		48.6%		
OPM	-194.7%	-59.0%	-67.3%			-74.3%		-47.6%		
NM	-187.9%	-55.6%	11.2%			11.0%		-42.2%		

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

Earnings revision: We factor in Iluvatar's 1H26 result and revise down our 2026E-2030E net income estimates by up to 12%, mainly on the impact of key components short supply. We revise down our 2026E-2030E revenues by -3% / -5% / -5% / -4% / -1%, considering the memory short supply may weigh on the company's AI computing board shipments growth. Our 2026E-2030E GMs are revised down to reflect the rising key components cost, while modeling a GM uptrend, as we believe the ASP adjustment of next generation products should alleviate the pressure of rising raw material cost. 2026E-2030E opex ratios are revised down to reflect the better-than-expected opex ratio in 1H26.

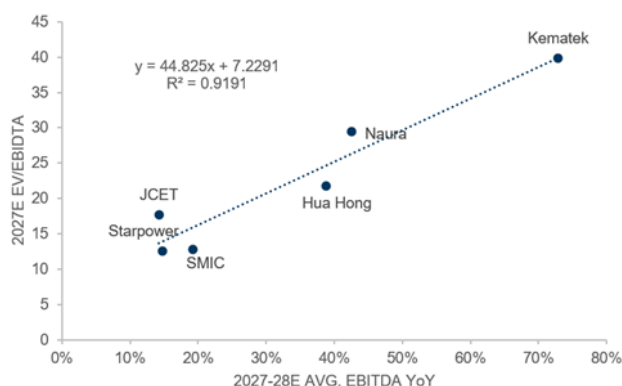
Exhibit 2: Earnings revision

Rmb m	2026E			2027E			2028E			2029E			2030E		
	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg	Old	New	Chg
Revenues	2,970	2,884	-3%	9,972	9,506	-5%	18,190	17,346	-5%	31,511	30,277	-4%	51,461	50,862	-1%
GP	1,431	1,001	-30%	5,065	4,376	-14%	9,326	8,245	-12%	16,097	14,861	-8%	26,192	25,384	-3%
EBITDA	-639	-746	na	1,364	1,238	-9%	3,493	3,251	-7%	6,940	6,753	-3%	13,174	13,010	-1%
Net income	4	-140	na	1,369	1,209	-12%	3,312	2,994	-10%	6,343	6,068	-4%	11,638	11,523	-1%
Margins															
GM	48.2%	34.7%		50.8%	46.0%		51.3%	47.5%		51.1%	49.1%		50.9%	49.9%	
OPM	-21.5%	-25.9%		13.7%	13.0%		19.2%	18.7%		22.0%	22.3%		25.6%	25.6%	
NM	0.1%	-4.9%		13.7%	12.7%		18.2%	17.3%		20.1%	20.0%		22.6%	22.7%	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

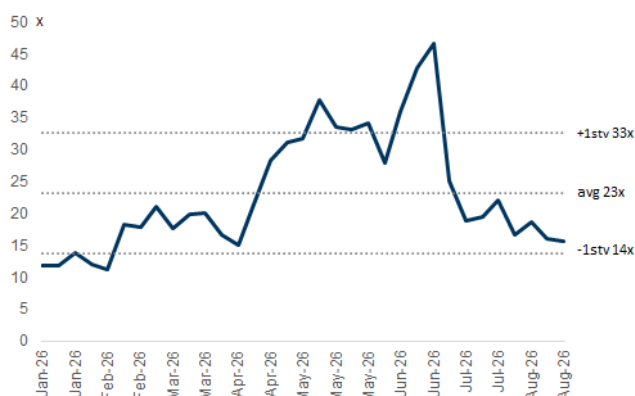
Valuation: We derive our 12M TP of HK\$859 (vs. HK\$1,000 previously) based on a discounted 2030E EV / EBITDA methodology to capture the company's long-term growth, in line with our GC Tech coverage. We apply a target EV / EBITDA multiple of 19.5x to our 2030E EBITDA (vs. 23.4x previously), and discount it back to 2027E using a COE of 12.7% (Beta of 1.5, Risk-free rate of 3.0%, and a market risk premium of 6.5%). Our target EV / EBITDA multiple is derived from: (1) peers' forward-year EV / EBITDA relative to average EBITDA YoY growth; and (2) Iluvatar's forward-year average EBITDA YoY growth (27% in 2031-32E). The target EV / EBITDA multiple cut is mainly on lower forward year EBITDA growth. **Maintain Buy.**

Exhibit 3: 2030E target EV / EBITDA of 19.5x is derived from the correlation between peers' EV / EBITDA and EBITDA growth



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Iluvatar 12M forward P/S



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Iluvatar 2030E discounted EV / EBITDA

Rmb m	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E	2032E
Iluvatar revenues (US\$m)		74	145	412	1,329	2,426	4,234	7,114	9,248	11,097
Iluvatar cloud chips (k units)		17	45	114	324	543	832	1,315		
Iluvatar cloud chips ASP (US\$)		3,296	2,986	3,471	3,959	4,301	4,876	5,186		
Revenue	289	540	1,034	2,884	9,506	17,346	30,277	50,862	66,120	79,344
Revenue YoY		87%	92%	179%	230%	82%	75%	68%	30%	20%
GM	49.5%	49.1%	54.0%	34.7%	46.0%	47.5%	49.1%	49.9%	49.9%	49.9%
GP	143	265	558	1,001	4,376	8,245	14,861	25,384	32,994	39,593
Opex ratio	327.3%	213.6%	155.5%	66.1%	34.3%	29.6%	27.4%	24.7%	24.5%	23.5%
OP	(803)	(887)	(1,050)	(907)	1,117	3,111	6,580	12,816	16,795	20,947
OPM	-277.8%	-164.5%	-101.5%	-31.4%	11.7%	17.9%	21.7%	25.2%	25.4%	26.4%
Non-op	(14)	(5)	46	766	139	108	87	130	130	130
Pretax profit	(817)	(892)	(1,004)	(140)	1,255	3,219	6,668	12,947	16,925	21,077
Tax	-	-	-	-	47	225	600	1,424	2,200	3,162
Tax rate	0%	0%	0%	0%	4%	7%	9%	11%	13%	15%
EBITDA	(698)	(747)	(894)	(746)	1,238	3,251	6,753	13,010	16,969	21,121
EBITDA YoY		na	na	na	na	163%	108%	93%	30%	24%
Net profit	(791)	(892)	(1,004)	(140)	1,209	2,994	6,068	11,523	14,725	17,916
NP YoY		na	na	na	na	148%	103%	90%	28%	22%
EPS			(5.31)	(0.58)	5.00	12.39	25.12	47.70	60.95	74.16
EPS YoY				na	na	148%	103%	90%	28%	22%
Target EV/EBITDA (sector EV/EBITDA)								19.5		
Target EV/EBITDA x 2030 EBITDA								254,125		
Enterprise value (Rmb, 2027E)					177,603					
Debt					2,086					
Cash					3,416					
Equity value (Rmb, 2027E)					178,932					
Value per share (HKD, 2027E): Target Price					859					
Implied EV/Sales				62	19	10	6	3	3	2
Implied P/E				na	148	60	29	16	12	10
COE	12.7%									
Beta	1.5									
Risk-free rate	3.0%									
Market risk premium	6.5%									

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Iluvatar

Valuation: Our 12-month target price of HK\$859 is based on 19.5x 2030E EV / EBITDA, discounted back to 2027E at COE of 12.7%. Our target EV / EBITDA multiple is derived from the peers' forward EV / EBITDA vs. EBITDA YoY correlation.

Key downside risks: Lower-than-expected AI chip demand in the China market; Fiercer-than-expected market competition; Slower-than-expected product migration.

9903.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$859.00	Price: HK\$311.60	Upside: 175.7%		
Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: HK\$75.3bn / \$9.6bn Enterprise value: HK\$73.5bn / \$9.4bn 3m ADTV: HK\$1.2bn / \$156.2mn China Greater China Technology M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	1,033.6	2,884.2	9,505.9	17,346.3
	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	(894.0)	(746.1)	1,237.6	3,250.7
	EPS (Rmb) New	(5.31)	(0.59)	5.00	12.39
	EPS (Rmb) Old	(5.31)	0.04	5.26	12.74
	P/E (X)	NM	NM	53.3	21.5
	P/B (X)	NM	16.0	12.5	7.9
	Dividend yield (%)	NM	0.0	0.0	0.0
	CROCI (%)	(38.8)	(0.8)	30.4	55.4
		6/26	12/26E	6/27E	12/27E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.43	(1.02)	1.34	3.66

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 11 Sep 2026 close.

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Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
19-Jul-26	1,000.00	495.20

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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